

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ J 6
♥ K Q T 8 3 2
♦ A 7
♣ A K 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 3
♥ J 9 6 4
♦ 8 6 2
♣ 9 6 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥		
	4 ♥	Pass	2 ♥
Pass			
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 1

[show NS] SOUTH's 2♥ raise shows 6-10 points and a least three trumps.

NORTH, with 19+ points, decides that game is almost a certainty and bids 4♥.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ T 9 7

♥ A 9 6

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ K 8 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A Q 4

♥ K T 8

♦ J T 9 5

♣ A J 6

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 2

[show NS] SOUTH has an ideal 1NT opening - 15 points and balanced distribution.

With 12 points, NORTH knows the partnership total is between 27 and 29, enough for game but not enough to think about slam. Since NORTH has no 4-card Major suit she bids 3NT.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ Q J 6 4

♥ A 9 5

♦ 8 2

♣ A K 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K T 7 3

♥ K 6

♦ T 7 5 4

♣ 8 5 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

All Pass
2 ♠ by South

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 3

[show NS] With 6 points, SOUTH must respond to NORTH's 1 ♣ opening bid. While it is often correct to respond by bidding suits "up-the-line", SOUTH should skip over the weak ♦ suit in favor of showing the 4-card Major ♠ suit.

NORTH knows that SOUTH may only have four ♠s, but with four of her own she can support the suit. Since she has a minimum opening bid she merely raises to 2 ♠. With his minimum response hand SOUTH passes.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ 7 5
♥ T 9 8 4
♦ K 9 4
♣ K 8 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 6
♥ A K Q 7 2
♦ A 5 3
♣ 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
All Pass 3♥ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 4

[show NS] With 17 points SOUTH is not strong enough to insist on game after NORTH's raise, but is strong enough to invite with a 3♥ bid.

NORTH, however, doesn't have anything extra, so declines to go further.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A 8 3 2

♥ K T 9

♦ A J 7

♣ K Q 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ T 9 4

♥ Q J 4

♦ K Q 5 2

♣ J 9 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 5

[show NS] This is a classic Notrump bidding sequence.

NORTH opens 1NT with 17 points and balanced distribution. SOUTH, with 9 points is not strong enough to bid game, but invites with 2NT. NORTH has a maximum, so she accepts the invitation.

Board 6
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K J 8 4

♥ A K 7 2

♦ 6 5

♣ K 9 3

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A Q T 6

♥ 5 4

♦ A 8 7 4

♣ A 8 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 6
[show NS] With two 4-card Majors NORTH should respond "up-the-line", bidding ♥s first.

Then, after SOUTH bids 1 ♠, NORTH has enough points to jump all the way to 4 ♠.

Board 7

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -	♠ K Q T 8 4	♠ -									
♥ -	♥ A 7	♥ -									
♦ -	♦ K Q 5	♦ -									
♣ -	♣ Q T 6	♣ -									
	<table><tr><td></td><td>N</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>W</td><td></td><td>E</td></tr><tr><td></td><td>S</td><td></td></tr></table>		N		W		E		S		
	N										
W		E									
	S										
	♠ A 9 6 3										
	♥ Q 6 4										
	♦ A 9 6 2										
	♣ J 7										

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 7

[show NS] NORTH has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers to open 1 ♠.

SOUTH has excellent ♠ support but with 11 points is not quite strong enough to insist on reaching game. Instead he makes an invitational jump to 3 ♠, which NORTH is strong enough to raise to game.

Board 8
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ 8 7

♥ T 6 4

♦ K Q T 9 6

♣ T 7 3

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A K 6

♥ A J 9

♦ A J 2

♣ A 8 5 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		2NT
All Pass 3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 8

[show NS] SOUTH has a powerful hand, but 21 points is not strong enough to start with a forcing 2♣ bid. Since he has balanced distribution he opens 2NT (20-21 points).

NORTH adds her 6 points to SOUTH's minimum and concludes they should be in game. She expects her good ♦ suit to be useful to NORTH in Notrump so she bids 3NT.

Board 9

North Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ J 6 3
♥ A K Q 8 2
♦ K 6
♣ T 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ T 9 5
♥ J 4
♦ Q J 8 3
♣ K J 7 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

1NT

All Pass
1NT by South

Baker Partnership-Basic Bidding 9

[show NS] NORTH has a solid 1 ♥ opening, 14 points and five trumps.

SOUTH must respond with 8 points, but cannot bid either minor suit since he needs at least 11 points to bid a new suit at the 2-level. So he bids 1NT (6-10 points).

NORTH doesn't object to Notrump so she passes.

None Vul

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 6 2

♥ K Q 7 5

♦ 83

♣ T 7 4



♠ K Q T 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6

 —
 —
 —
 —

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♠

All Pass
2♠ by South

1♠

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 10

[show NS] SOUTH has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

NORTH has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to $2\spadesuit$, passed by SOUTH.

NORTH does not consider showing the ♥s, first because she knows there is a ♠ fit, and second because she doesn't have the 11 points needed to bid a new suit at the 2-level.

Board 11
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 8 3

♥ A 7

♦ K J 9 6 4

♣ Q J 5

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K J 4

♥ K Q 9 2

♦ A Q 5

♣ K T 8

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	6NT

All Pass
6NT by North

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 11
[show NS] With balanced distribution and 16 points
NORTH should open 1NT rather than 1♦.

SOUTH's response is based on simple math. He adds his 18 points to the 15 minimum that NORTH has announced and comes up with 33 points combined. This is enough for a small slam, and since he has balanced distribution he bids 6NT.

Board 12
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 4
 ♥ Q T 6
 ♦ 8 5 3 2
 ♣ Q 9 8 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J T 9 6
 ♥ A 7
 ♦ A Q 6
 ♣ A K 7

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 12
 [show NS] SOUTH is right at the maximum for a 1 ♠ opening bid - one more point and he would have opened 2 ♣.

NORTH does not have 3-card ♠ support but with 7 points must make some response. She cannot bid at the 2-level so she says 1NT (6-10 points).

SOUTH is fine with Notrump so he bids 3NT.

Board 13

North Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ Q J T 8 3
♥ A J 4
♦ A T
♣ 9 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 9 6 4
♥ K Q 5
♦ K Q J 7
♣ 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♥	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass 6 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 13

[show NS] NORTH has a minimum 1 ♠ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps. She doesn't even suspect what's about to befall!

SOUTH hears the 1 ♠ bid and all he wants to know is whether NORTH has one, two or three Aces. So he uses the Blackwood convention, 4NT.

NORTH has two Aces so she bids 5 ♥ (5 ♣ would show zero Aces, 5 ♦ would show one Ace, etc).

SOUTH has heard enough and bids 6 ♠.

Board 14
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 7 4

♥ Q 5

♦ K 7 6 4

♣ 7 6 5 3

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ 6 2

♥ A K 8 7 6 2

♦ A T 3

♣ A 9

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 14

[show NS] SOUTH has an above-minimum strength hand with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1♥.

NORTH, with 9 points, is a little too weak to bid at the 2-level so she bids a catchall 1NT.

SOUTH shows his 6-card suit and extra strength by jumping to 3♥, which NORTH raises to 4♥ since two trumps is now adequate support.

Board 15

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -	♠ K Q 7 4	♠ -
♥ -	♥ 8 3	♥ -
♦ -	♦ 7 6 2	♦ -
♣ -	♣ A K Q 2	♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ J T 8 3
♥ A Q 7 4
♦ J 5 3
♣ 7 6

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
All Pass			
2 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 15

[show NS] NORTH has 14 points and opens her 4-card ♣ suit.

SOUTH must respond, and with two 4-card Majors bids them "up-the-line", saying 1 ♥.

NORTH now shows his 4-card ♠ suit, and SOUTH again must bid. Since SOUTH is pretty weak he just raises to 2 ♠, which NORTH happily passes.

Board 16

South Deals

None Vul

♠ —



◆ —

♣ —

♠ A 9 4

♥ A 7

◆ K 8 3

♣ K J 9 6 2



♠ —



◆ —

♣ —

♠ K Q 7

♥ K Q J 3

◆ AT 6

♣ Q T 8

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

4NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass 6NT by South

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 16

[show NS] SOUTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT bid.

NORTH, with 16 points, can't tell if there are enough points for slam. If SOUTH has 17 points then a slam should be makeable, but if SOUTH has only 15 points then he should settle for game.

The 4NT raise solves the problem. It tells SOUTH to bid 6NT with 17 points, pass with 15 points, and use best judgment with 16. Here SOUTH bids the slam.

Board 17

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K 9 7 3

♥ 8 4 2

♦ A K 5

♣ J 7 6

♠ A Q 8 6 2

♥ J 5 3

♦ 7 4

♣ K Q 2

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠		
All Pass			
3 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 17

[show NS] NORTH has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding. But when SOUTH opens 1 ♠ NORTH should show her "almost opening strength" by jumping to 3 ♠.

SOUTH has just 13 points, and knowing NORTH has less than 13 he passes.

Board 18
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ 7 3

♥ Q 8 6 4 2

♦ A 8 6

♣ K 9 5

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ T 8 2

♥ A K 7 5 3

♦ K Q 5

♣ Q 6

West	North	East	South
Pass	4♥		1♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 18
[show NS] After SOUTH opens with 1♥, NORTH has a small "dilemma". With 11 points she really is only strong enough to make a jump raise to 3♥. But, with five trumps the hand deserves more. So she just bids 4♥ instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your partner opens with you should just jump right to game.

Board 19

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ Q J 7 5
♥ A
♦ A K Q 3
♣ K T 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K T 8 3
♥ J 7 2
♦ 9 8 6
♣ Q J 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♦	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 19

[show NS] NORTH has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit. With two 4-card minor suits she should start with 1 ♦.

SOUTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. His first priority is to show a Major suit so he responds 1 ♠.

NORTH now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so she revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for game. She bids 4 ♠.

Board 20
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ -	♠ T 9 6 3	♠ -
♥ -	♥ 7 5 4	♥ -
♦ -	♦ Q 7	♦ -
♣ -	♣ A K 6 4	♣ -

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 7 4
♥ K Q 2
♦ A J 6
♣ 9 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 20

[show NS] NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

SOUTH has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1 ♠ rather than 1NT. NORTH isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2 ♠. SOUTH has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3 ♠. NORTH has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4 ♠.

Board 21

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -	♠ K J 3	♠ -
♥ -	♥ K Q 5	♥ -
♦ -	♦ A Q J	♦ -
♣ -	♣ K J 4 2	♣ -
	W N E S	
	♠ Q T 8	
	♥ A J 6	
	♦ K T 9 3	
	♣ Q T 5	

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	4NT
All Pass 4NT by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 21
[show NS] NORTH has a perfect 2NT opening hand, 20 points and 3-3-3-4 distribution.

SOUTH, with 12 points of his own, knows the partnership is borderline strong enough for slam. Since he is happy with Notrump, he invites NORTH to bid slam by responding 4NT.

With one more point NORTH might bid the slam, but here she just passes.

Board 22
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ J T 4

♥ A J 6

♦ K 5 3

♣ T 8 7 2

♠ 9 6 5

♥ K Q 2

♦ A 8 7

♣ K Q J 3

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 22
[show NS] SOUTH opens 1NT with 15 points and a balanced hand.

NORTH, with 9 points, cannot bid game herself, but she can invite SOUTH to bid game if he has the maximum 17 point opener. So she responds 2NT.

SOUTH doesn't have maximum, he has minimum, so he passes.

West	North	East	South
Pass	2NT		1NT
All Pass 2NT by South			

Board 23
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ Q T 8 2

♥ A K

♦ 7 6 4

♣ A K Q 5

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ J 9 7 5

♥ 6 4 2

♦ A K J

♣ 7 4 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 23
[show NS] NORTH is 1 point too strong to open 1NT, so opens 1 ♣.

SOUTH responds in his 4-card Major suit, 1 ♠.

NORTH now shows her 4-card support plus her extra strength by jumping to 3 ♠ and SOUTH bids the game.

Board 24
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ 5 4 3

♥ A 7 2

♦ K T 6 5

♣ 9 8 5

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K Q J

♥ K Q 8

♦ Q J 9 3

♣ A K 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		2NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicBidding 24
[show NS] SOUTH has a classic 2NT opening bid, 21 points and balanced distribution.

NORTH knows that her 7 points will be plenty for game, but not enough to consider slam so she just bids 3NT.